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Federal Acquisition Certification in Contracting (FAC-C)

Program Evolution Reference Guide

From Establishment (2006) Through Modernization to FAC-C (Professional) (2023)

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Section 1: Executive Summary

1.1 The Federal Acquisition Certification in Contracting (FAC-C) program was established on January 20, 2006, by OMB Deputy Director for Management Clay Johnson III, pursuant to the Office

of Federal Procurement Policy (OFPP) Policy Letter 05-01, "Developing and Managing the Acquisition Workforce," issued April 15, 2005. The program was developed under the authority of 41 U.S.C. §1101 et seq. (the OFPP Act) and applicable provisions therein.

1.2 The fundamental objective of the FAC-C program is to establish standardized education, training, and experience requirements for civilian agency contracting professionals, primarily those serving in the GS-1102 Contract Specialist occupational series. The program was designed to mirror Department of Defense (DoD) Defense Acquisition Workforce Improvement Act (DAWIA) requirements as closely as practicable, facilitating workforce mobility and ensuring consistent professional standards across the federal acquisition workforce.

1.3 The FAC-C program is administered by individual civilian executive agencies with oversight provided by the Federal Acquisition Institute (FAI), operating under the direction of the OFPP Associate Administrator for Acquisition Workforce Programs.

1.4 Since its inception, the program has undergone several significant revisions:

- **December 2008:** Updated training course curriculum, refined elective requirements, and published equivalency course crosswalks for the transition from legacy Defense Acquisition University (DAU) courses.
- **May 2014:** Additional programmatic updates to align with evolving acquisition workforce needs.
- **January 19, 2023:** Comprehensive modernization memorandum issued by Lesley A. Field, Deputy Administrator for Federal Procurement Policy, transitioning from the legacy three-level FAC-C structure to a single-level FAC-C (Professional) certification, effective February 1, 2023.

1.5 The 2023 modernization represents the most significant structural transformation since the program's establishment. It replaces the legacy tiered certification model with a single, competency-based professional certification aligned with the ANSI-accredited contracting competency model (ANSI/NCMA ASD 1-2019), incorporates a professional certification examination, and establishes bi-directional parity with DoD contracting professional certification under DAWIA.

KEY REFERENCE

This document consolidates requirements from the original January 2006 FAC-C memorandum, the December 2008 revision, and the January 19, 2023, FAC-C (Professional) modernization memorandum into a single reference guide for the civilian acquisition workforce.

Section 2: Original FAC-C Program (January 2006)

2.1 Purpose

2.1.1 Section 1 of the original FAC-C program memorandum established the core purpose: to define standardized requirements for education, training, and experience for contracting professionals serving in civilian executive agencies. The program was designed to ensure that federal contracting officers and contract specialists possess the fundamental knowledge, skills, and abilities necessary to effectively execute the government's acquisition mission in accordance with applicable statutes, regulations, and policies.

2.2 Authority

2.2.1 As set forth in Section 2 of the program memorandum, the FAC-C program was established under the following authorities:

- **OFPP Act, Section 6(a)** — General authority of the Administrator for Federal Procurement Policy
- **OFPP Act, Section 6(c)(5)** — Authority regarding acquisition workforce programs
- **OFPP Act, Section 37(b)(3) and (g)** — Provisions governing the Federal Acquisition Institute and acquisition workforce training
- **OFPP Policy Letter 05-01, paragraph 8(b)** — Directive requiring development of certification programs for the acquisition workforce

2.3 Background

2.3.1 As documented in Section 3 of the program memorandum, OFPP Policy Letter 05-01 required the Federal Acquisition Institute (FAI) to develop, and the Chief Acquisition Officers Council (CAOC) to approve, a certification program for the contracting workforce. The FAC-C program was developed through a collaborative interagency process and received CAOC approval in December 2005. The program memorandum was subsequently issued on January 20, 2006, with phased implementation timelines.

2.4 Applicability

2.4.1 Section 4 of the program memorandum established the following applicability provisions:

Provision	Detail
Covered Agencies	All executive agencies except those subject to the Defense Acquisition Workforce Improvement Act (DAWIA), codified at 10 U.S.C. §§1741–1746.
Mandatory Date	Certification required for all new Contracting Officer (CO) warrants issued on or after January 1, 2007.
Existing Workforce	Personnel holding CO warrants prior to January 1, 2007, were not required to obtain initial certification but were encouraged to do so and were subject to continuous learning requirements.
Exceptions	Senior officials exercising inherent procurement authority; emergency procurement situations; limited/micro-purchase warrants as determined by the agency Senior Procurement Executive (SPE).

2.5 Program Oversight

2.5.1 Section 5 of the program memorandum established the oversight and administration framework:

- **FAI Board of Directors:** Provided strategic oversight of the program, including approval of substantive policy changes and periodic program reviews.
- **Federal Acquisition Institute (FAI):** Served as the administering body, responsible for program management, guidance issuance, system of records maintenance, and interagency coordination.
- **Periodic Agency Audits:** FAI was authorized to conduct periodic audits of agency certification programs to ensure compliance with established requirements.
- **Certification Authority:** Certification was managed at the Senior Procurement Executive (SPE) level, with delegation authority to the agency Acquisition Career Manager (ACM) as appropriate.

2.6 Core Requirements

2.6.1 Competencies

2.6.1.1 As specified in Section 6(a), the FAC-C program was built upon a common set of acquisition competencies aligned across the federal acquisition workforce. These competencies defined the knowledge, skills, and abilities expected at each certification level and were maintained and published on the FAI website. Competencies were periodically reviewed and updated to reflect evolving acquisition requirements, statutory changes, and best practices.

2.6.2 Education

2.6.2.1 Section 6(b) established education requirements in accordance with the GS-1102 Qualification Standard promulgated by the Office of Personnel Management (OPM).

EDUCATION REQUIREMENT COMPARISON

Population

Requirement

Civilian Non-DoD (GS-5 through GS-12)

Baccalaureate degree

OR

24 semester hours in specified business disciplines

DoD (DAWIA-covered)

Baccalaureate degree

AND

24 semester hours in specified business disciplines

FAC-C Level III (all)

Baccalaureate degree

AND

24 semester hours in specified business disciplines

2.6.3 Training

2.6.3.1 Section 6(c) required that civilian agencies follow the Defense Acquisition University (DAU) curriculum for core contracting courses. All core training courses were required to be DAU courses or DAU-equivalent courses approved through an established equivalency process. Elective courses were agreed upon between the employee and their immediate supervisor and were intended to support individual professional development aligned with organizational mission needs.

2.6.4 Experience

2.6.4.1 Section 6(d) established experience requirements based on the GS-1102 Qualification Standard. Experience was measured as time on the job in progressively responsible contracting assignments. Both public sector (federal, state, or local government) and private sector contracting experience qualified toward meeting the experience requirement, provided the work involved substantive contracting duties.

2.6.5 Continuous Learning

2.6.5.1 Section 6(e) mandated 80 Continuous Learning Points (CLPs) every two years, with the initial continuous learning period beginning October 1, 2007. Qualifying activities included:

- Formal training courses and seminars
- Professional activities (conferences, workshops, professional organization participation)
- Educational activities (academic coursework, publications, teaching)
- Experience-based activities (rotational assignments, mentoring, special projects)

2.7 Three-Level Certification Structure

2.7.1 Section 7 of the program memorandum established a three-tiered certification structure with progressively increasing requirements.

Element	Level I	Level II	Level III
Education	Baccalaureate degree OR 24 semester hours in business disciplines	Baccalaureate degree OR 24 semester hours in business disciplines	Baccalaureate degree AND 24 semester hours in business disciplines
Training	CON 100, CON 110, CON 111, CON 112, CON 120, plus 1 elective (minimum 16 hours)	CON 214, CON 215, CON 216, CON 217, CON 218, plus 2 electives (minimum 16 hours each)	CON 353, plus 2 electives (minimum 16 hours each)
Experience	1 year of contracting experience	2 years of contracting experience	4 years of contracting experience

NOTE

Level II training courses listed above reflect the December 2008 revision. The original January 2006 memorandum specified CON 202, CON 204, and CON 210 as Level II core courses. See Section 3 for details on the 2008 course transition.

2.8 Ways to Meet Requirements

2.8.1 Section 8 of the program memorandum identified the following pathways to satisfy certification requirements:

- **DAU Training:** Completion of required DAU courses directly.
- **DAU-Equivalent Courses:** Completion of agency or vendor courses that had received formal DAU equivalency determination through the established fulfillment process.
- **DAWIA Equivalency:** Personnel holding DAWIA certification in contracting could receive equivalent FAC-C certification, provided they met the applicable FAC-C education criteria. The fulfillment process was aligned with DoD procedures to ensure consistency.

2.9 Application Process

2.9.1 Section 9 established the certification application process. Applications were submitted through the employee's immediate supervisor, with certification decisions made at the SPE level. SPEs were authorized to delegate certification authority to the agency ACM. The process required documented evidence of meeting all applicable education, training, and experience requirements at the requested certification level.

2.10 System of Records

2.10.1 Section 10 designated the Acquisition Career Management Information System (ACMIS) as the official system of records for FAC-C certifications, training histories, and continuous learning point tracking. All agencies were required to ensure timely and accurate data entry into ACMIS for their acquisition workforce members.

Section 3: December 2008 Revision

3.0.1 In December 2008, the FAC-C program memorandum was revised to update the training curriculum and refine several program requirements. The key changes are summarized below.

3.1 Updated Level II Training Courses

3.1.1 The most significant change was the replacement of the original Level II core training courses. The legacy courses (CON 202, CON 204, and CON 210) were replaced with an expanded and updated curriculum:

Original Level II Courses (2006)	Revised Level II Courses (2008)
CON 202	CON 214
CON 204	CON 215
CON 210	CON 216
—	CON 217
—	CON 218

3.2 Elective Requirements

3.2.1 The revision added a minimum 16-hour requirement for all elective courses at every certification level. This standardized the elective requirement and ensured that elective training provided substantive professional development value. The requirement applied to:

- **Level I:** 1 elective (minimum 16 hours)
- **Level II:** 2 electives (minimum 16 hours each)
- **Level III:** 2 electives (minimum 16 hours each)

3.3 DAWIA-to-FAC-C Equivalency

3.3.1 The revision added an explicit education criteria requirement for DAWIA-to-FAC-C equivalency determinations. Personnel seeking FAC-C certification based on existing DAWIA certification were required to demonstrate compliance with the applicable FAC-C education requirements (baccalaureate degree and/or 24 semester hours) in addition to holding the DAWIA certification.

3.4 Implementation Timeline

3.4.1 The revised requirements were implemented on a phased timeline:

Requirement	Effective Date	Notes
Core training courses (CON 214–218)	FY2009 (October 1, 2008)	New enrollments required to follow revised curriculum
Elective minimum hour requirement	FY2010 (October 1, 2009)	Applied to all new elective completions

3.5 Equivalency Course Crosswalk

3.5.1 To facilitate the transition, an Equivalency Course Crosswalk was published mapping legacy DAU courses to their revised equivalents. This crosswalk enabled personnel who had completed or partially completed training under the original 2006 curriculum to receive appropriate credit toward the revised requirements. The crosswalk was maintained and published by FAI in coordination with DAU.

Section 4: FAC-C Modernization — FAC-C (Professional) (January 2023)

4.0.1 On January 19, 2023, Lesley A. Field, Deputy Administrator for Federal Procurement Policy, issued a comprehensive modernization memorandum that rescinded and replaced all prior FAC-C memoranda. The modernized program, designated FAC-C (Professional), became effective February 1, 2023.

4.1 Key Drivers for Modernization

4.1.1 The modernization was driven by multiple converging factors:

- **DoD DAWIA Transformation:** The Department of Defense had significantly restructured its acquisition workforce certification framework under the "Back-to-Basics" initiative, necessitating corresponding updates to the civilian certification program to maintain parity.
- **Training Delivery Evolution:** The shift toward virtual instructor-led and asynchronous learning modalities, accelerated by the COVID-19 pandemic, required fundamental changes to the training delivery model.
- **Talent Attraction and Retention:** The need to modernize certification pathways to attract and retain qualified contracting professionals in an increasingly competitive labor market.
- **Public Priority Advancement:** The imperative to equip the contracting workforce with competencies to advance emerging public priorities, including equity, sustainability, domestic sourcing, and cyber security.
- **Section 861 Compliance:** Section 861 of the FY2020 National Defense Authorization Act (NDAA) required updates to acquisition workforce certification programs across the federal government.

4.2 Transformational Shifts

4.2.1 The FAC-C (Professional) program introduced six fundamental transformational shifts from the legacy program:

#	From (Legacy FAC-C)	To (FAC-C Professional)	Significance
1	Three-level certification structure	Single-level certification	Simplifies career progression; aligns with DoD model
2	Classroom-heavy training model	Virtual instructor-led learning	Increases access; reduces travel costs and time-to-certification
3	No formal credentialing program	Curated credentials program	Provides targeted, role-specific professional development
4	Centralized, one-size-fits-all framework	Agency/supervisor-driven development	Enables tailored workforce development aligned with mission
5	Non-standardized competency model	ANSI-accredited competency model (ANSI/NCMA ASD 1-2019)	Industry-recognized standard; enhances credibility and rigor
6	No certification examination	Professional certification exam required (CON 3990V)	Validates competency attainment; establishes professional standard

4.3 FAC-C (Professional) Requirements

4.3.1 Competencies

4.3.1.1 The FAC-C (Professional) competency framework is based on the DoD Contracting Competency Model (June 2020), which is founded upon the ANSI-accredited ANSI/NCMA ASD 1-2019 standard. The competency model encompasses both buyer and seller perspectives in the contracting process, reflecting the full spectrum of knowledge, skills, and abilities required for effective contract management across the acquisition lifecycle.

4.3.2 Experience

4.3.2.1 FAC-C (Professional) requires 12 months of full-time experience applying a representative sample of technical contracting competencies. Qualifying experience may be gained in either government or industry positions, provided the work involves substantive application of contracting competencies as defined by the competency model.

4.3.3 Training

4.3.3.1 The FAC-C (Professional) training curriculum consists of four core virtual courses delivered through DAU:

Course	Title	Description
CON 1100V	Contract Foundational Skills	Fundamental contracting principles, authorities, ethics, and market research
CON 1200V	Contract Pre-Award	Requirements development, solicitation, evaluation, and source selection
CON 1300V	Contract Award	Contract formation, negotiation, award documentation, and debriefings
CON 1400V	Contract Post-Award	Contract administration, modifications, performance management, and closeout

4.3.4 Credentials

4.3.4.1 The FAC-C (Professional) program introduced a curated credentials program consisting of job-relevant learning packages designed to provide targeted professional development beyond core certification. Credentials leverage DAU credential offerings supplemented by civilian-specific content. The credentials program is governed by the Federal Government Credential Board (FGCB), approved by OFPP, and maintained by FAI.

4.3.5 Professional Examination

4.3.5.1 A contracting professional certification examination (CON 3990V) is required for FAC-C (Professional) certification. The examination validates attainment of core contracting competencies as defined by the competency model. An optional examination preparation course is available to assist candidates, but completion of the prep course is not a prerequisite for sitting for the examination.

4.3.6 Continuous Learning

4.3.6.1 The FAC-C (Professional) program requires 100 Continuous Learning Points (CLPs) per two-year common period, beginning May 2024. This represents an increase from the legacy 80 CLP requirement and aligns with the DoD continuous learning standard. The common period ensures all certified professionals operate on a synchronized cycle.

4.3.7 Education

4.3.7.1 The formal education requirement has been removed from FAC-C (Professional) certification requirements. Education requirements remain in effect under the GS-1102 Qualification Standard administered by OPM for purposes of position classification and hiring, but are no longer a gating factor for professional certification.

IMPORTANT DISTINCTION

While education is no longer a FAC-C (Professional) certification requirement, the GS-1102 Qualification Standard continues to require a baccalaureate degree and/or 24 semester hours

in business disciplines for appointment to the GS-1102 series. Agencies must continue to apply OPM qualification standards for hiring and promotion actions.

4.4 Parity with DoD

4.4.1 A critical design objective of the FAC-C (Professional) program is the establishment of bi-directional parity with the DoD contracting professional certification. Under the legacy FAC-C program, equivalency was generally recognized in only one direction (DAWIA to FAC-C). The modernized program positions FAC-C (Professional) as equivalent to the DoD Contracting Professional Certification, enabling personnel to move between civilian and defense acquisition positions with full certification reciprocity.

4.5 FAC-COR Reciprocity

4.5.1 Personnel holding FAC-C (Professional) certification are recognized as meeting the requirements for all levels of the Federal Acquisition Certification for Contracting Officer's Representatives (FAC-COR). This reciprocity eliminates the need for dual certification and recognizes that the contracting professional competency framework encompasses the COR competency requirements.

4.6 Learning Management System

4.6.1 The legacy Federal Acquisition Institute Training Application System (FAITAS) was replaced by FAI Cornerstone OnDemand (CSOD) as the official learning management and certification tracking system. The transition to FAI CSOD was completed in June 2021. FAI CSOD serves as the system of record for certification status, training transcripts, continuous learning point tracking, and credential management.

Section 5: Transition Framework

5.0.1 Attachment 2 of the January 2023 modernization memorandum established a comprehensive transition framework addressing five distinct scenarios for personnel in various stages of the legacy FAC-C certification process. The transition framework ensured that no workforce member lost credit for completed training while providing clear pathways to the new FAC-C (Professional) certification.

5.1 Transition Scenarios

Scenario 1: No Training Started

Situation: Individual has not commenced any FAC-C training under the legacy program.

Action: Begin the FAC-C (Professional) certification pathway. Complete all four core courses (CON 1100V–1400V), professional examination (CON 3990V), experience requirement (12 months), and continuous learning requirements.

Scenario 2: Legacy Level I Started, Not Completed

Situation: Individual has begun but not completed legacy FAC-C Level I training.

Action: Complete legacy Level I requirements by September 30, 2023, and receive Level I certification (which will then convert per Scenario 3), OR discontinue legacy training and begin the FAC-C (Professional) pathway.

Scenario 3: Legacy Level I Earned, Level II Not Started

Situation: Individual holds legacy FAC-C Level I certification and has not commenced Level II training.

Action: Automatically certified as FAC-C (Professional). Individual must earn CLPs in accordance with the new continuous learning requirements. No additional training or examination required.

Scenario 4: Legacy Level I Earned, Level II Started

Situation: Individual holds legacy FAC-C Level I and has begun but not completed Level II training.

Action: Complete legacy Level II requirements by September 30, 2023 (certification to be awarded by October 31, 2023), OR discontinue Level II training and receive automatic FAC-C (Professional) certification based on Level I completion.

Scenario 5: Legacy Level II Earned, Level III Started

Situation: Individual holds legacy FAC-C Level II and has begun but not completed Level III training.

Action: Complete legacy Level III requirements by September 30, 2023 (certification to be awarded by October 31, 2023), OR discontinue Level III training and retain FAC-C (Professional) certification based on Level II completion.

5.2 Key Transition Dates

Date	Action
February 1, 2023	FAC-C (Professional) effective date; new certifications issued under Professional framework only
September 30, 2023	Deadline for submission of legacy certification applications (Scenarios 2, 4, 5)
October 31, 2023	Deadline for agencies to process and grant legacy certifications for timely applications
May 2024	Beginning of first common CLP period under FAC-C (Professional)

5.3 Records Preservation

5.3.1 All legacy FAC-C certifications (Levels I, II, and III) remain recorded in the individual's FAI CSOD transcript as permanent records of professional achievement. Legacy certifications are not revoked but are superseded by FAC-C (Professional) certification for purposes of warrant eligibility and career management.

Section 6: Roles and Responsibilities

6.0.1 Attachment 3 of the January 2023 modernization memorandum defined the roles and responsibilities of key stakeholders in the FAC-C (Professional) program. The following roles are detailed below:

Role	Responsibilities
OFPP Associate Administrator for Acquisition Workforce Programs	Provides overall policy direction for the FAC-C (Professional) program Approves revisions to certification requirements and competency models Ensures alignment with government-wide acquisition workforce objectives Oversees FAI execution of program administration responsibilities

Role	Responsibilities
Federal Acquisition Institute (FAI)	Administers the FAC-C (Professional) program on behalf of OFPP Maintains and operates FAI CSOD as the system of record Coordinates training curriculum development with DAU Manages the credentials program in coordination with FGCB Publishes program guidance, FAQs, and implementation resources Conducts periodic agency compliance reviews Reports program metrics and workforce data to OFPP
Chief Acquisition Officer (CAO) / Senior Procurement Executive (SPE) / Agency Leadership	Ensures agency compliance with FAC-C (Professional) requirements Establishes agency-level policies and procedures for certification management Designates Acquisition Career Managers (ACMs) and defines delegation of authority Ensures adequate resources for workforce training and professional development Oversees the linkage between certification and warrant issuance
Acquisition Career Managers (ACMs)	Manages day-to-day certification operations within the agency Reviews and processes certification applications Verifies education, training, experience, and examination requirements Ensures accurate data entry and maintenance in FAI CSOD Coordinates transition activities for legacy certification holders Serves as primary point of contact for workforce certification inquiries
Small Agency Representatives (SARs)	Performs ACM-equivalent functions for small agencies that may lack dedicated ACM positions Coordinates with FAI for certification processing and technical assistance Facilitates access to training opportunities for small agency personnel Participates in the Inter-Agency Acquisition Career Management Committee (IACMC) as appropriate
Contracting Managers and Supervisors	Supports employee professional development and certification attainment Approves and documents qualifying experience for certification purposes Endorses certification applications and continuous learning plans Identifies appropriate credential and elective training opportunities Ensures employees maintain current certification and CLP requirements
Contracting Professionals	Completes all required training, examination, and experience requirements Maintains certification through continuous learning point attainment Maintains accurate records in FAI CSOD including training completions and CLPs Pursues relevant credentials to enhance professional competency Communicates with supervisor and ACM regarding certification status and development needs

Section 7: Continuous Learning Points (CLP) Guide

7.1 CLP Requirements Comparison

Element	Legacy FAC-C (2006)	FAC-C Professional (2023)
CLP Requirement	80 CLPs per 2-year period	100 CLPs per 2-year common period
Period Start	October 1, 2007 (individual anniversary dates)	May 2024 (synchronized common period)
Period Structure	Individual rolling 2-year periods	Government-wide common 2-year periods
Qualifying Activities	Training, professional activities, education, experience	Training, professional activities, education, experience, credentials

7.2 CLP Point Values Reference

7.2.1 The following table consolidates CLP point values as established in Appendix B of the original 2006 FAC-C memorandum. These point values provide guidance for calculating CLPs across qualifying activity categories:

TRAINING AND EDUCATION		
Activity	**CLP Value**	**Limits / Notes**
Academic courses (quarter/semester hour)	10 CLPs per credit hour	Per quarter or semester hour
Academic courses (per CEU)	10 CLPs per CEU	Continuing Education Units
DAU courses	10 CLPs per CEU	As recorded on DAU transcript
Awareness briefing	0.5 CLPs per hour	Short informational sessions
Continuous learning modules	1 CLP per hour	Online or self-paced modules
Other functional training	1 CLP per hour	Agency or vendor training

PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES		
Activity	**CLP Value**	**Limits / Notes**
Professional exam/license	10–30 CLPs	Per exam or license attained
Teaching (acquisition-related)	2 CLPs per hour	Maximum 20 CLPs per year
Presentations (professional forums)	2 CLPs per hour	Maximum 20 CLPs per year
Workshop participation	1 CLP per hour	Maximum 8 CLPs per day; 20 CLPs per year
Conference attendance	0.5 CLPs per hour	Maximum 4 CLPs per day; 20 CLPs per year
Publications (acquisition-related)	10–40 CLPs	Based on scope and significance of publication

EXPERIENCE-BASED ACTIVITIES		
Activity	**CLP Value**	**Limits / Notes**
On-the-job developmental assignments	Varies	Maximum 20 CLPs per year
IPT/Special Project Leader	Varies	Maximum 15 CLPs per year
IPT Member	Varies	Maximum 10 CLPs per year
Mentor	Varies	Maximum 5 CLPs per year
Rotational assignments	5–80 CLPs	Based on length: 1–3 months (5–20 CLPs); 3–6 months (20–40 CLPs); 6–12 months (40–80 CLPs)

Section 8: Education Requirements Reference

8.1 GS-1102 Qualification Standard

8.1.1 The GS-1102 Contract Specialist qualification standard, administered by the Office of Personnel Management (OPM), establishes the minimum education and experience requirements for appointment to the GS-1102 occupational series. These requirements operate independently of FAC-C certification requirements and continue to apply for hiring, promotion, and position classification actions.

8.2 24 Semester Hours Requirement

8.2.1 As detailed in Appendix A of the original 2006 FAC-C memorandum, the 24 semester hours must be distributed across the following business discipline subject areas, as defined by the American Council on Education:

#	Qualifying Business Discipline
1	Accounting
2	Business Law
3	Business
4	Finance
5	Contracts

#	Qualifying Business Discipline
6	Purchasing
7	Economics
8	Industrial Management
9	Marketing
10	Quantitative Methods
11	Organization and Management

8.3 Education Requirement Summary by Program Version

Program Version	Certification Education Req.	GS-1102 Standard
Legacy FAC-C Level I	BA/BS OR 24 sem. hrs.	Applies per OPM standard
Legacy FAC-C Level II	BA/BS OR 24 sem. hrs.	Applies per OPM standard
Legacy FAC-C Level III	BA/BS AND 24 sem. hrs.	Applies per OPM standard
FAC-C (Professional)	Removed from certification	Continues to apply per OPM standard

KEY DISTINCTION

The removal of the education requirement from FAC-C (Professional) certification does not eliminate the education requirement for the GS-1102 occupational series. Agencies must continue to verify education qualifications under OPM standards for all personnel actions involving GS-1102 positions. The change affects only the certification pathway, not the underlying position qualification requirements.

Appendix A: Key Regulatory References

Reference	Description
OFPP Policy Letter 05-01	"Developing and Managing the Acquisition Workforce" (April 15, 2005). Established the policy framework requiring development of federal acquisition certifications, including FAC-C, FAC-COR, and FAC-P/PM.

Reference	Description
41 U.S.C. §1101 et seq.	Office of Federal Procurement Policy Act. Provides statutory authority for OFPP to prescribe policies and procedures for acquisition workforce management, including the Federal Acquisition Institute.
10 U.S.C. §§1741–1746	Defense Acquisition Workforce Improvement Act (DAWIA). Establishes the DoD acquisition workforce certification framework. FAC-C program applicability excludes agencies subject to DAWIA.
FAR 1.602-2	Federal Acquisition Regulation provision governing Contracting Officer responsibilities and qualifications. Links warrant authority to professional qualification standards.
ANSI/NCMA ASD 1-2019	ANSI-accredited Contract Management Standard of Practice published by the National Contract Management Association. Foundation for the DoD Contracting Competency Model and FAC-C (Professional) competency framework.
Section 861, FY2020 NDAA	Section 861 of the National Defense Authorization Act for Fiscal Year 2020. Required updates to acquisition workforce certification programs across the federal government, contributing to the impetus for FAC-C modernization.

Appendix B: Key Contacts and Resources

Resource	Location	Description
Federal Acquisition Institute (FAI)	fai.gov	Official FAI website. Program information, policy documents, certification guidance, and workforce data.
Defense Acquisition University (DAU) Catalog	dau.edu	Course catalog, registration, training schedules, and credential information for DAU and DAU-equivalent courses.
OFPP Contact	MBX.OMB.OFPPv2@OMB.eop.gov	Office of Federal Procurement Policy general inquiries regarding acquisition workforce policy and certification programs.
FAI Cornerstone OnDemand (CSOD)	Accessed via fai.gov	Official learning management system and certification system of record. Training registration, transcript management, CLP tracking, and certification applications.

Appendix C: Acronym Glossary

Acronym	Definition
ACM	Acquisition Career Manager
ACMIS	Acquisition Career Management Information System
ANSI	American National Standards Institute
CAO	Chief Acquisition Officer
CAOC	Chief Acquisition Officers Council
CLP	Continuous Learning Point
CO	Contracting Officer
CPARS	Contractor Performance Assessment Reporting System
CSOD	Cornerstone OnDemand (Learning Management System)
DAU	Defense Acquisition University
DAWIA	Defense Acquisition Workforce Improvement Act
FAC-C	Federal Acquisition Certification in Contracting
FAI	Federal Acquisition Institute
FAITAS	Federal Acquisition Institute Training Application System (legacy; replaced by CSOD)
FAR	Federal Acquisition Regulation
FGCB	Federal Government Credential Board
IACMC	Inter-Agency Acquisition Career Management Committee
NCMA	National Contract Management Association
NDAA	National Defense Authorization Act
OFPP	Office of Federal Procurement Policy
OMB	Office of Management and Budget
OPM	Office of Personnel Management
SAR	Small Agency Representative
SPE	Senior Procurement Executive

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